

ALAN JAMES

Designer. Developer. Founder.



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SUMMARY

Award-winning product designer with 30 years at the intersection of design and development. Co-founded a platform that became the verb for festival production worldwide, and shipped products for Qantas, Westpac, and Service NSW that moved real numbers. I design things that get built — and I build things that move metrics.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

2x conversion uplift on highest-trafficked page — Qantas Credit Card Selector

Good Design Award Gold 2024 — Loadin (zero advertising, organic global adoption)

\$1.02m first-year EBIT from 12 CRO experiments — Qantas Health Insurance (target was \$0.5m)

Universal booking platform serving 8 million citizens — Service NSW

290% uplift in home loan applications — Westpac Wonder (form completion 1.67% → 9.25%)

EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Designer & Experimentation Practice Lead — Qantas Loyalty

Sep 2024 — present

- Invited to return to own the Credit Card Selector — highest-trafficked page in Financial Services, a data-rich filtering experience across all Qantas Points Earning Credit Cards
- 2x conversion uplift through rapid CRO experimentation using core principles: de-cluttering, zoning and signposting
- Achieved complex page layout A/B tests using Optimizely with JavaScript Observers and DOM manipulation — bypassing scheduled dev releases entirely
- Proposed faceted search flow aligned with major marketplace filtering patterns, currently in quantitative and qualitative research
- Appointed Practice Lead for experimentation across the Financial Services tribe — mentoring teams on rapid test-and-learn methodology
- Product Designer for Embedded Loyalty platform (formerly LaaS) — federated component system for partner banking apps, moving from ANZ pilot to NAB re-platform

Co-founder & Product Designer — Loadin.com

Jul 2017 — present

- Zero to global platform powering SXSW, Reading & Leeds, Live Nation UK, and the UK Olympic homecomings
- Good Design Award Gold (Digital Design) + Good Design Award (Service Design) 2024
- Designed, architected and built the entire product — UX, front-end, IA, and component-based design system with 100+ custom SVG icons
- Co-design model with SME from Laneway Festival using Lean UX and customer-centred design principles
- Entirely organic growth — \$0 ad spend, adopted by word of mouth across 3 continents
- Architecture scaled from 1 festival to 1,000+ acts at SXSW without structural changes
- Handed operations to GM and development to engineering team — business thrives independently

Design Principal — Pragmateam / Service NSW

Apr 2020 — Apr 2023

- Expanded scope from a driving test booking fix to a universal booking platform for 8 million NSW citizens — including Service Centre appointments, parent-teacher meetings, and all State Government departments
- Built data-rich, responsive HTML prototype that served dual purpose: citizen usability testing and executive stakeholder buy-in
- Ran usability testing across regional/rural and culturally & linguistically diverse (CALD) cohorts — 7/8 and 6/8 task success
- Card sorting workshops with Service Centre managers to restructure IA across 181 transaction types
- Promoted to Design Principal — led all design across the consultancy; mentored junior and offshore designers
- Facilitated Design Sprints with prospective clients to win new business; part of the team that scoped and priced end-to-end projects

Senior Experience Designer & CRO Specialist — Qantas Ventures

Jul 2019 — Apr 2020

- 12 CRO experiments generating \$1.02m annual EBIT and \$2.1m lifetime EBIT (business plan target was \$0.5m/\$1m)
- 10,700 new call centre leads through purchase funnel optimisation for Qantas Health Insurance
- 11 of 12 experiments successful — designed in Sketch, handed off to dedicated React developer, measured daily via Google Optimize
- Created gamified digital results wall for stakeholder visibility — signed off by Olivia Wirth (CEO, Loyalty) and Alan Joyce (CEO, Qantas)
- Engaged to expand remit to digital conversions and Web Simplification project (design system / atomic design approach)
- Contract extension agreed before COVID resulted in CRO team being stood down

Consultant — Welcome to Country

Sep 2018 — Aug 2019

- Initially engaged pro-bono via Westpac; left to consult directly on this Indigenous-led tourism marketplace
- Three-person design team reporting directly to the CEO — evaluated technical approach for tactical and strategic phases
- Optimised purchase path for greatest conversion through the funnel
- Now the leading Indigenous marketplace in the southern hemisphere

Practice Lead, Prototyping & CX Lead — Westpac

Nov 2014 — Sep 2018

- Initially 2IC within a team re-imagining online business banking for St. George — built fully functioning, data-driven high-fidelity prototype testing how large businesses use banking differently to retail
- CX Lead on flagship Westpac Wonder home ownership program — redesigned 17-page hub-and-spoke form into 9-page linear journey
- 290% increase in Approval in Principle applications; form completion 1.67% → 9.25%; 52% decrease in completion time
- 6 rounds of usability testing in 12 weeks — changes from Tuesday tests live in prototype by Thursday
- Established HTML prototyping practice for Westpac Next / Customer Centred Design team — real-world end-to-end hypothesis testing, adopted at executive level for 'north star' vision buy-in
- Part of working party that modernised the Westpac GEL design system towards Atomic Design

UX Lead — Web Applications — Thomson Reuters

Apr 2010 — Jul 2014

- Full discovery-to-build responsibility for Checkpoint tax and accounting research platform
- Redesigned flagship Westlaw legal research platform — aligning aesthetic, brand and usability with Checkpoint
- Established global application experience branding for all existing and future Thomson Reuters web applications

Director — Adventia

Jun 2008 — Apr 2010

- Design and development consultancy — client websites and digital projects

Senior Developer / Experience Designer — Expedia AU/NZ

Nov 2006 — Jun 2008

- Helped Expedia with AU/NZ market entry — all aspects from design through to booking engine manipulation
- Purchase path optimisation and A/B testing of landing pages for campaigns

SKILLS

Product Design · UX Design · Interaction Design · Information Architecture · Design Systems · CRO / Experimentation · HTML / CSS / JavaScript · Prototyping · Usability Testing · Stakeholder Engagement · Agile · Accessibility · AngularJS · AI-augmented Design

AWARDS

Good Design Award Gold — Digital Design, Apps & Software (2024)

Loadin.com — up against multinationals with budgets we couldn't dream of

Good Design Award — Service Design, Commercial Services (2024)

Loadin.com — first nomination in 30 years, two wins

EDUCATION

MSc by Research: The Business Case for the Internet

University of Salford (1998)

BEng (Hons) Computers, Management & Electronics (2:1)

University of Salford (1996)

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